

Acer Chromebook 314 C936T

IT Intern Repair Guide

Ottumwa High School | IT Department

Version 1.0 | 2025-2026 School Year | By: James Ockenfels

Key Contacts

Supervisor: Jane Doe

IT Lead: John Doe

When in doubt, ask. Escalate all software, OS, enrollment, and unfixable hardware issues to John Doe through Jane Doe.

A Note on This Guide

The HP Chromebook 14 G7 guide was written after nearly two years of hands-on experience with that device. This guide is different. It was written based on a single teardown and rebuild of one Acer C936T, combined with information from the official Acer service manual. Most repair concepts carry over from the HP, and the procedures here are accurate to the best of my knowledge, but this guide has not been tested across many repairs or edge cases. Treat it as a solid starting point, use good judgment, and update it as you learn more about this device.

Quick Reference, Find Your Problem

Use this table to jump to the right section. Each section starts on its own page.

Problem / Symptom	Section to Go To
Back cover needs to come off / starting a repair	Issue 1, Base Cover Removal
Battery needs replacing / device won't charge	Issue 2, Battery Replacement
Keys broken or not registering	Issue 3, Keyboard Replacement
Touchpad not working	Issue 4, Touchpad Replacement

Cracked or broken screen	Issue 5, Screen Replacement
Screen black / no image / no backlight	Issue 6, Display Cable Swap
Camera not working	Issue 7, Camera Replacement
Top shell cracked or damaged	Issue 8, Top Assembly Removal
Device is slow or has a minor issue	Issue 9, Powerwash
Software problem / OS damaged	ESCALATE
Enrollment issues	ESCALATE
Device cannot be repaired	Part it, verify with Jane or John first

Rules You Must Know Before Starting Any Repair

- **Always keep the device upside down after removing the base cover. The battery is not screwed in and will fall out if you flip it over.**
- **Do NOT Powerwash IHCC student devices. They have an authenticator that will break.**
- **Always disconnect the battery before touching internal components or connectors.**
- The camera module bends very easily. Always handle it gently and use minimal force.
- Any device that cannot be repaired must be parted out, but verify first with Jane Doe or John Doe.
- Always update the ticket with proper ticket etiquette when working on a device that has one.
- The asset ID is on the sticker on the bottom of the device, or in the top-right corner of the login screen.

Tools

We use the iFixit Pro Repair Kit for all repairs. Make sure the kit is available before you start. You will also need:

- Jimmy / spudger / pry tool, for opening base cover seams and releasing keyboard clips
- Plastic tweezers, for tape, ribbon cables, and small connectors
- Parts cart, replacement parts are kept here

NOTE: ESD (static electricity) is worth being aware of. Avoid working on carpet if you can, and try not to touch circuit board traces or connector pins directly. We don't use wrist straps routinely but being mindful helps.

Key Differences from the HP Chromebook 14 G7

If you are already familiar with the HP 14 G7, here are the most important differences to know before working on the Acer C936T.

HP Chromebook 14 G7	Acer Chromebook 314 C936T
8 bottom screws, 2 different lengths that must not be mixed up	10 bottom screws, all identical size with small washers
Battery is screwed in and stays put	Battery is not screwed in. It is held only by the back cover and will fall out if you flip the device over after removing it.
Keyboard lifts out after prying seam, no locking screw	Keyboard has a small locking screw on that must be removed before taking the keyboard out
Keyboard ribbon uses ZIF latch connectors only	Keyboard ribbon uses a latch connector and is additionally held by Kapton tape
Touchpad has 4 bracket screws and 3 direct screws	Touchpad has 3 screws and 5 pieces of tape that must all be lifted before the screws are accessible
Small plastic clips around the edges	6 clips along the bottom edge, pry left to right
Top and bottom shells slide apart after hinge screws are removed	Top assembly simply lifts away after 3 hinge screws per side are removed, much simpler
Separate camera cable runs through the hinge	Camera and display share one LVDS cable. There is no separate camera cable.

Parts Reference

These diagrams and component lists are sourced from the official Acer Lifecycle Extension Guide for the Chromebook C936T. They are included here so you can quickly identify parts by name and location. For more detailed part information, including additional diagrams, removal sequences, and specifications, refer to the full Acer guide at the link shown below.

Source: Acer Official Lifecycle Extension Guide

Diagrams for reference. All parts are kept on the parts cart, you do not need to look up part numbers for day-to-day repairs.

For more detailed part information, refer to the full Acer Lifecycle Extension Guide at:
https://global-download.acer.com/GDFiles/Document/Lifecycle%20Ext.%20Guide/Lifecycle%20Ext.%20Guide_Acer_1.0_A_A.pdf?acerid=638327897300642649&Step1=&Step2=&Step3=C936T&OS=ALL&LC=en&BC=ACER&SC=PA_6

Figure 1, System Components (Exploded View)

This diagram shows the main components of the Acer C936T. Use it to identify part names and their locations inside the device.

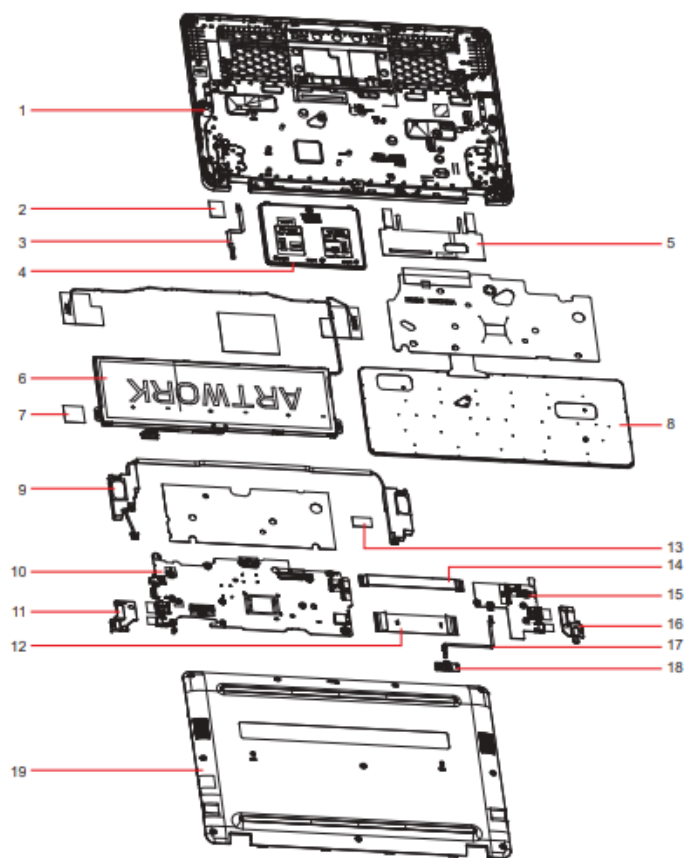
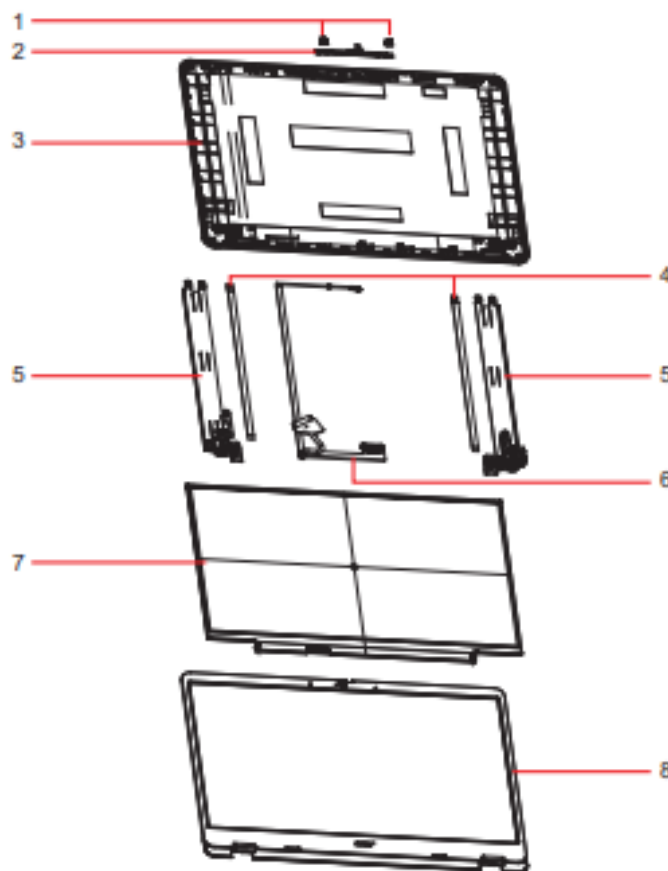


Table 1, System Components

1. Top assembly
2. Mylar on FFC
3. Touchpad FFC
4. Touchpad module
5. Conductive fabric for the touchpad module
6. Battery
7. Acetate tape for battery cable connector
8. Keyboard
9. Speaker module
10. Mainboard
11. Right I/O bracket
12. USB board FFC (high speed)
13. Thermal pad
14. USB board FFC (low speed)
15. USB board
16. Left I/O bracket
17. Hall sensor board FFC
18. Hall sensor board
19. Base cover

Figure 2, LCD Assembly Components

This diagram shows the parts that make up the display assembly. Use it to identify components during screen, camera, and cable repairs.

**Table 2, LCD Assembly Components**

1. Microphone rubbers
2. Camera module
3. LCD cover (top shell / back cover of display)
4. LCD adhesive tape
5. Hinges (left and right)
6. LVDS cable (carries both display signal and camera signal)
7. LCD panel
8. LCD bezel

Source: Acer Official Lifecycle Extension Guide

For complete part numbers, additional diagrams (cable routing, screw locations), and full disassembly sequences, see the Acer Lifecycle Extension Guide:

https://global-download.acer.com/GDFiles/Document/Lifecycle%20Ext.%20Guide/Lifecycle%20Ext.%20Guide_Acer_1.0_A_A.pdf?acerid=638327897300642649&Step1=&Step2=&Step3=C936T&OS=ALL&LC=en&BC=ACER&SC=PA_6

Issue 1, Base Cover Removal

You need to do this before almost every other repair. The base cover is held by 10 screws and a row of plastic clips around the edges.

WARNING: All 10 screws have small washers on them. These can fall off, keep track of them. All 10 screws are the same size so mixing them up is not a concern on this model.

1. Power off the device and unplug the charger. Remove any connected cables and the microSD card if one is inserted.
2. Flip the device upside down. Remove all 10 Phillips screws from the base cover. The layout is 3 across the top, 3 in the middle, and 4 across the bottom. Each screw has a small washer, do not lose them.
3. Insert a pry tool into the seam at the bottom right corner(the hinges should be facing you) and run it along and pry up till you release the clips.
4. Work your way around all edges until all clips release, then lift the base cover straight up and off.

WARNING: Keep the device upside down after removing the back cover. The battery is not screwed in and will fall out if you flip the device over.

NOTE: To reinstall, place the cover back on and press around all edges to snap the clips in, then replace all 10 screws.

Issue 2, Battery Replacement

Do this when the device won't charge or the battery holds very little charge. Test with a different charger first before doing this repair.

1. Remove the base cover (Issue 1). Keep the device upside down.
2. Find the clear mylar tape overlapping the battery cable, keyboard cable, and mouse cable. Lift it back gently.
3. Find the black acetate tape covering the battery connector specifically. Lift that tape back to expose the connector.
4. Pull back on the battery connector to disconnect it from the mainboard.
5. Lift the battery straight out. It is not screwed in and simply lifts free.
6. Place the new battery in. Plug the connector back in.
7. Place the black tape back over the connector to protect it. Make sure the black tape is not tucked underneath the battery.
8. Place the clear mylar tape back over the keyboard and touchpad connectors.
9. Reinstall the base cover.

TIP: Make sure the black tape sits on top of the battery edge, not underneath it. If it gets trapped under the battery it will put stress on the connector.

Issue 3, Keyboard Replacement

Do this when keys are physically broken or not registering. The Acer keyboard uses a locking screw, a latch connector, Kapton tape, and 6 clips along the bottom seam. Read through all steps before starting.

Step A, Disconnect the Keyboard from the Inside

1. Remove the base cover (Issue 1) and disconnect the battery (Issue 2 steps 2 through 4).
2. Find the clear mylar tape covering the keyboard and touchpad connectors. Lift it back.
3. Find the small black screw on the bottom left of the keyboard connector and unscrew it.
4. Lift the small black plastic latch on the connector to unlock it, then pull the ribbon cable straight out.
5. The ribbon cable is also held down by Kapton tape (yellow and transparent). Carefully peel that tape up and set it aside.

Step B, Remove the Keyboard from the Top

1. Flip the device back over (right-side up) and open the lid.
2. Insert a thin pry tool into the seam at the bottom left corner of the keyboard.
3. Run the tool to the right along the bottom seam. There are 6 clips total, evenly spaced, roughly a quarter to a half inch from each end and about an inch and a half apart. When you reach a clip, gently pry upward to release it from its recess, then move on to the next one.
4. Once all 6 clips are released, lift the keyboard from the front edge and pull it gently toward you. Guide the ribbon cable up through the hole in the top assembly as you go.

Step C, Reinstall

1. Guide the ribbon cable down through the hole in the top assembly.
2. Insert the back edge of the keyboard first, sliding it all the way in before pressing the front down flush.
3. Go over each clip position with a jimmy tool and press each clip down so it seats back into its recess. Work methodically from one end to the other.
4. Flip the device over. Lay the Kapton tape back over the keyboard ribbon cable, then slide the ribbon into the latch connector, press the latch down, and reinstall the locking screw.
5. Lay the clear mylar tape back over the keyboard and touchpad connectors, reconnect the battery, and reinstall the base cover.

TIP: The clip reinstall step is the hardest part. Try a wider flat plastic tool to press more evenly on the clip area if the jimmy is not working well.

Issue 4, Touchpad Replacement

Do this when the touchpad is physically broken or not working after reseating the cable. There are several layers of tape to manage, go slowly and note where each piece comes from.

1. Remove the base cover (Issue 1) and disconnect the battery (Issue 2 steps 2 through 4).
2. You do not need to disconnect the motherboard side of the touchpad cable, just the touchpad side.
3. There are 5 total pieces of tape you need to lift up from the mouse pad, and plastic mouse pad bracket
4. The tape on the far left has a small extra piece of clear plastic tape over it that covers the touchpad-side connector. Lift that too.
5. Disconnect the touchpad cable from the touchpad connector.
6. Peel the tape up and unscrew the 3 screws. Flip the device right-side up and open the lid, the touchpad can now be lifted free.

Reinstall

1. Slide the new touchpad into the slot with the screw holes facing toward the keyboard and the front edge (facing you) going in first.
2. Screw the 3 screws back in.
3. Lay all the tape back down in the order you removed it. Plug the touchpad cable into the touchpad side, then lay the small clear tape over that connector.
4. Lay the clear mylar tape back over everything, reconnect the battery, and reinstall the base cover.

NOTE: You probably do not need to unplug the motherboard side of the touchpad cable, just disconnect and reconnect on the touchpad side.

Issue 5, Screen Replacement

Do this when the screen is physically cracked or confirmed non-functional. If the screen is simply black, check Issue 6 (Display Cable) first.

WARNING: A black screen alone does not mean the panel is bad. Test with an external monitor before replacing the screen.

1. Remove the base cover (Issue 1) and disconnect the battery.
2. Disconnect the LVDS cable from the mainboard connector and unroute it from underneath the mainboard edge.
3. Remove the 3 hinge screws on each side (6 total). Open the lid fully, then extend both hinges until they are fully open.
4. Carefully pull the top assembly (the lid) away from the bottom. The display assembly is now free.
5. Remove the LCD bezel (see Issue 5b below).
6. On the top corners of the screen, find the 2 small pull tabs located between the 2 metal mounting tabs. Carefully pull these tabs to release the adhesive strips holding the screen in.
7. Gently lift the screen from the top and fold it carefully face-down onto the LCD cover. The LVDS cable is still attached.
8. Detach the mylar tape securing the LVDS cable to the back of the screen, then lift the latch on the panel connector and disconnect the cable.
9. Connect the new screen and test before applying adhesive to the sides of the screen on the metal, not the white back light. Once confirmed working, use adhesive to reattach the screen, reinstall the bezel, hinge screws, and base cover.

Issue 5b, Bezel Removal

The bezel must be removed before you can access the screen or camera.

1. Start from the inside lip on the camera (top) side and carefully pry along both sides working toward the bottom.
2. At the hinge covers, unclip the hinge covers from the rest of the shell before prying, then carefully bend the bezel around the hinge itself.
3. Continue working around until all clips are released, then remove the bezel.

WARNING: The camera module bends very easily. Be extremely gentle around the top of the display assembly.

Issue 6, Display Cable Swap

Do this when the screen won't turn on at all, or turns on but has no backlight. On the Acer C936T, the LVDS cable carries both the display signal and the camera signal, one cable does both jobs.

NOTE: Unlike the HP 14 G7, there is no separate camera cable. The display cable (LVDS) runs through the left hinge and connects both the screen and the camera to the motherboard.

Step A, Quick Test

1. Remove the base cover (Issue 1) and disconnect the battery.
2. Disconnect the LVDS cable from the mainboard. Plug in a test cable from the cart and connect a test screen to it. If the test screen lights up and works, the original cable is bad, continue to Step B. If the test screen also doesn't work, the mainboard is likely damaged. Escalate to John Doe or Jane Doe.

Step B, Full Cable Replacement

3. Remove the hinge screws (3 per side, 6 total) and separate the top assembly from the bottom (Issue 5 steps 3 and 4).
4. Remove the LCD bezel and screen (Issue 5 steps 5 through 8).
5. Release the LVDS cable from the left hinge cap and unroute it from the cable guides on the LCD cover.
6. Peel the old cable off and route the new cable the same way. Reconnect the camera connector (pull straight up to connect) and the screen connector.
7. Test the screen and cable together before applying adhesive. If it works, reattach the screen with adhesive, reinstall the bezel, top assembly, hinge screws, and base cover.

Issue 7, Camera Replacement

Do this when the camera is not working. Follow these steps in order, start simple before doing a full cable replacement.

WARNING: The camera module bends very easily. Always use minimal force when prying it out.

Step A, Check the Cable First

On the motherboard side, verify the LVDS cable port is plugged in securely and doesn't look damaged. If it looks fine and the camera still doesn't work, continue.

Step B, Replace the Camera Module

1. Remove the LCD bezel (Issue 5b).
2. Locate the camera at the top center of the display assembly. Carefully slide a pry tool underneath it and gently lift. Do not bend it.
3. Pull directly upward on the small connector on top of the camera to disconnect it from the LVDS cable.
4. Install the replacement camera, press the connector back down, and test. If the camera works, reinstall the bezel and you're done.
5. If the camera still doesn't work after a new module, the LVDS cable may be the issue. See Issue 6 for cable replacement.

Issue 8, Top Assembly Removal

Do this when the top shell (the back cover of the display) is physically damaged. This is much simpler on the Acer C936T than on the HP 14 G7, no cable routing through hinge gaps is needed.

1. Remove the base cover (Issue 1) and disconnect the battery.
2. Disconnect the LVDS cable from the mainboard connector and unroute it from underneath the mainboard edge.
3. Remove the 3 screws from each hinge (6 total).
4. Open the lid fully, then extend both hinges until they are fully open.
5. Carefully pull the top assembly away from the bottom. The two halves separate cleanly.
6. To reinstall a new top assembly, align it with the hinges, seat it, and screw in the 6 hinge screws. Route the LVDS cable back along the same path, reconnect it to the mainboard, reconnect the battery, and reinstall the base cover.

TIP: Separation is much simpler than the HP. There is no cable routing through the hinge gaps, the cable simply disconnects at the motherboard end.

Issue 9, Powerwash (Factory Reset)

A Powerwash clears all local data and resets ChromeOS to a clean state. Try this first for slowness, app crashes, or minor software issues. It does NOT delete anything in Google Drive.

WARNING: Do NOT Powerwash IHCC student devices. Their authenticator will break and they will lose access to their accounts.

Method 1, Developer Mode Trick (Our School's Method)

This is the method set up by the school. It triggers a Powerwash rather than actually enabling developer mode.

- Press Esc + Refresh + Power at the same time to enter recovery mode.
- Press Ctrl + D when prompted.
- Hit Enter a few times when asked. The school has it configured to Powerwash instead of enabling developer mode.

Method 2, Keyboard Shortcut

From the login screen (not while signed in), press Shift + Alt + Ctrl + R. A Powerwash prompt will appear. Follow the on-screen steps.

NOTE: The Settings menu method does not work on some school-managed devices. Use Method 1 or Method 2 above.

After a Powerwash completes, the device will ask for a Google account login. Make sure the student signs in with their school account so it re-enrolls on the school network correctly.

If a Powerwash does not fix the issue, or the device cannot be Powerwashed, escalate to John Doe or Jane Doe. Do not attempt OS recovery or enrollment changes yourself.

When to Escalate, and When to Part a Device

Always Escalate to John Doe or Jane Doe

- Any software issue, OS problem, or ChromeOS error screen
- Enrollment issues or anything with Google Admin
- IHCC student devices needing a Powerwash, do not do it yourself
- Damaged mainboard or USB-C port
- Any repair you are unsure about, ask before you make it worse

Parting a Device

If a device truly cannot be repaired, it should be parted out so its components can be used on future repairs.

- Always verify with Jane Doe or John Doe before parting a device.
- Useful donor parts: screens, keyboards, batteries, touchpads, cameras, cables, shells.
- Label the parted components clearly and store them on the parts cart.

General Tips

- Always test a repair before fully reassembling. It is much easier to fix a connection while everything is open.
- Take a photo before disconnecting cables or removing components so you have a reference.
- If a screw is stripped, don't force it, ask for help.
- Update the ticket using proper ticket etiquette any time you work on a device that has one.
- The asset ID is on the sticker on the bottom of the device, or shown in the top-right corner of the login screen.

Good luck, and welcome to the IT team.